

Raj Pidugu

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity Analyst with 5+ years of experience in IAM, PAM, SIEM, and threat detection, leveraging AI/ML for anomaly detection, risk scoring, and log summarization. Proficient in Splunk, QRadar, CyberArk, and OKTA, with expertise in automating vulnerability management, reducing MTTR/MTTD, and ensuring compliance with NIST, PCI DSS & SOX. Proven record of enhancing security posture, driving cross-functional incident response, and strengthening cloud identity security in AWS environments.

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst, Arkana Infotech, United States Jan 2025 — Present

- **Security Monitoring & Incident Response:** Monitored 200+ security alerts daily using Splunk and QRadar; leveraged ML-based anomaly detection models to cut false positives by 30% and reduce triage time by ~2 hours/week, strengthening business operations.
- **Identity & Access Management:** Implemented RBAC and conducted access audits across 3 core systems, reducing unauthorized access incidents by 45%, securing sensitive data for over 1,500 employees and avoiding potential compliance penalties.
- **Vulnerability Assessment:** Automated scanning with Nessus and OWASP ZAP; integrated Python ML scripts to prioritize risks by exploit likelihood, remediating 50+ critical risks within 72 hours, saving ~80 man-hours/month and reducing exposure to high-risk threats.
- **Security Awareness Campaigns:** Supported rollout of phishing simulations and training, achieving a 60% drop in phishing failures, improving staff compliance, and reducing potential phishing-related downtime by ~12 hours/month.

Cybersecurity Analyst, WM, Houston, United States Jan 2022 — Jan 2025

- **Identity Security Implementation:** Deployed OKTA-based identity & PAM solutions, reducing unauthorized access from 20 to 5 cases per quarter, protecting ~2,000 corporate accounts and preventing potential financial/data loss.
- **Automated Threat Detection:** Integrated security tools into CI/CD pipelines; applied AI-based behavioral analytics for login anomalies, saving 40+ analyst hours/month, reducing incident triage by 15 minutes per event, and cutting mean time to detect (MTTD) by 20%.
- **Vulnerability Risk Reduction:** Performed forensic analysis and weekly assessments, eliminating 12+ high-priority risks within 3 months and preventing ~\$50K in potential remediation costs.
- **Custom Security Alerts:** Built 20+ detections in Splunk for login anomalies and configuration changes; experimented with LLM-based log summarization, tripling real-time visibility, doubling Tier-1 analyst response efficiency, and improving response time for critical systems.
- **Incident Response Coordination:** Conducted mock drills and RCA sessions, improving SLA adherence from 85% to 97%, enhancing cross-team coordination for ~500 IT support tickets per month.
- **Cloud & Endpoint Security:** Hardened cloud workloads and endpoint configurations by aligning with NIST and CIS benchmarks, reducing misconfigurations by 35% and strengthening resilience against external attacks.
- **Security Awareness & Reporting:** Delivered monthly executive dashboards and employee awareness sessions, boosting phishing simulation pass rates by 25% and ensuring leadership had actionable insights for decision-making.

Cybersecurity IAM Analyst & Intern, WNS Global Services, India Jan 2020 — Jul 2021

- **Privileged Access Management:** Deployed CyberArk PAM (PSM, PSMP) across critical systems, reducing unauthorized access by 40%, securing 500+ enterprise accounts and avoiding compliance breaches.
- **User Provisioning Automation:** Automated onboarding/offboarding via Active Directory and SailPoint, reducing manual workload by ~30 hours/month, accelerating access grant turnaround by 50%, and saving ~\$10K/year in operational costs.
- **Incident Response & Forensics:** Investigated 100+ access-related events, improving SLA adherence by 25% and reducing potential breach windows for critical enterprise systems.
- **RBAC Audits:** Performed audits across 5+ enterprise systems, revoking 80+ obsolete permissions, ensuring compliance for ~1,200 user accounts and preventing unauthorized access incidents.

PROJECTS

Privileged Access Management (PAM) Integration Framework

- Designed and implemented a CyberArk-based PAM framework integrating EPV, PVWA, Active Directory, and AWS IAM, automating password rotations with Python to cut manual effort by 50% and ensure PCI DSS/SOX compliance. Incorporated ML-driven risk scoring for privileged sessions to flag anomalous activity, reducing investigation workload by ~30% and strengthening insider threat detection.

Agent-Computer Interface(ACI) for Dynamic Vulnerability Detection

- Engineered and extended OSS-Fuzz-gen's infrastructure to support custom projects, evaluated LLMs for fuzzing harness generation, build orchestration, and runtime analysis, and identified vulnerabilities in 4 Java libraries (args4j, java-util, jolt), boosting fuzzing efficiency by 71.43% and strengthening crash and memory leak detection.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ | OKTA Certified Professional | Google IT Security | AWS Cloud Practitioner | SIEM: Event Management with Splunk Security

EDUCATION

University of Houston - Clear Lake, Houston, United States - Masters, Computer Science

Gandhi Institute of Engineering and Technology, Visakhapatnam, India - Bachelors, Computer Science

SKILLS

Cybersecurity & Identity Management	: IAM, PAM, RBAC, OKTA, CyberArk (PSM, PVWA, PSMP), Privileged Access Management, Threat Detection, Incident Response, Vulnerability Assessment
SIEM & Monitoring	: Splunk, QRadar, Microsoft Sentinel, Security Monitoring, Log Analysis, LLM-based Log Summarization, AI/ML-driven Anomaly Detection
Vulnerability & Risk Tools	: Nessus, OWASP ZAP, Qualys, OpenVAS, Penetration Testing, Risk Prioritization, Exploit Likelihood Assessment
Cloud & Automation	: AWS (IAM, Cloud Security), Microsoft Azure, Active Directory, SailPoint, EPV, PVWA, Python (automation & ML scripts), PowerShell, Bash, CI/CD Integration, Fuzzing Harness Automation
Frameworks, Compliance & AI/ML	: NIST, MITRE ATT&CK, PCI DSS, SOX, ITIL, Security Policies & Compliance, ML-based Threat Detection, Behavioral Analytics, Risk Scoring, OSS-Fuzz-gen